

Seeding QDArchive

Part 2: Data Classification Report

ISIC Rev. 5 Classification of Qualitative Research Projects

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Repository:	https://github.com/hussainrifat/QDArchive

Dataset Overview

Repository	QDA Projects	QD Projects	Other	Not a Project	Total
FSD Finland	0	4	399	0	403
Dryad	1	340	498	14	853
Total					1256

1. INTRODUCTION AND METHODOLOGY

This report presents the results of Part 2 of the Seeding QDArchive project, conducted as part of the Applied Software Engineering Project seminar at FAU Erlangen (Winter 2025/26 + Summer 2026) under the supervision of Prof. Dr. Dirk Riehle. The project's objective is to populate QDArchive — a new repository for qualitative research data — by acquiring and classifying publicly available qualitative research datasets from two assigned repositories.

1.1 SCOPE OF CLASSIFICATION

Part 1 of this project acquired 1,256 qualitative research projects from Dryad and the Finnish Social Science Data Archive (FSD Finland), storing full metadata in a structured SQLite database. Part 2 classifies these projects across two dimensions: project type (based on the files contained) and economic sector (using the ISIC Rev. 5 standard).

1.2 PROJECT TYPE CLASSIFICATION

Each project was assigned one of four mutually exclusive types based on all file records associated with that project, including files that failed to download. Using all file records — rather than only successfully downloaded files — was a critical methodological decision: 3,342 Dryad files were rate-limited during acquisition and recorded as FAILED_SERVER_UNRESPONSIVE. Classifying on downloaded files only would have incorrectly treated these projects as having no files.

- QDA_PROJECT** — project contains at least one QDA analysis file (.qdp_x, .nvp, .mx24)
- QD_PROJECT** — no QDA file, but contains primary data files (.txt, .pdf, .docx, .doc)
- OTHER_PROJECT** — no QDA or primary files, but other data files present
- NOT_A_PROJECT** — no file type information available

1.3 ISIC REV. 5 CLASSIFICATION

All 1,256 projects were classified into the International Standard Industrial Classification of All Economic Activities, Revision 5 (ISIC Rev. 5) at two hierarchical levels: Section (single letter, A–V) and Division (two-digit numeric code). Classification was performed using the Anthropic Claude API (claude-haiku-4-5), which received each project's title, description, and keywords and returned the most appropriate Section and Division along with a confidence rating (high, medium, or low).

In addition to project-level classification, each primary data file (.txt, .pdf, .docx, .doc, .xlsx, .csv, etc.) belonging to QDA_PROJECT and QD_PROJECT types was individually classified using its filename and parent project context, covering 1,764 files.

1.4 REPORT STRUCTURE

Results are presented as four distributions organised by repository and project type: (1) Dryad × QDA_PROJECT, (2) Dryad × QD_PROJECT, (3) FSD Finland × QDA_PROJECT, and (4) FSD Finland × QD_PROJECT. Each distribution includes a histogram of identified ISIC classes with counts, a rank-ordered table of the top classes, and a discussion of findings. Section 4 provides a comparative analysis across both repositories.

2. Repository 1: Dryad

Dryad — QDA Projects: ISIC Division Distribution

Distribution 1 · 1 project · 1 distinct ISIC division R-86

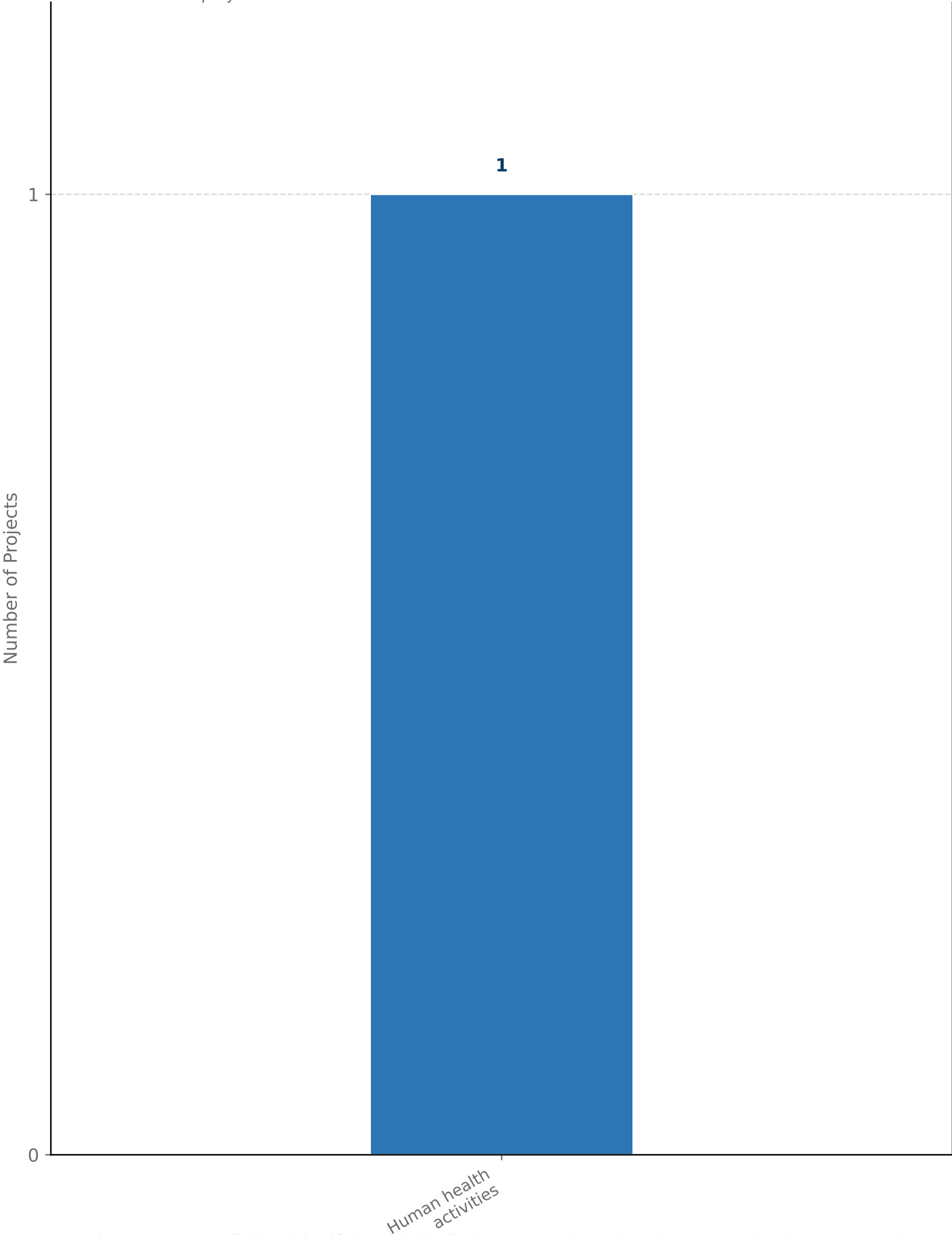


Figure: ISIC Rev. 5 divisions identified in this distribution. Counts shown above bars. ISIC codes shown on top axis.

2. Repository 1: Dryad

Dryad — QDA Projects: Ranked Class Table and Findings

Distribution 1 · 1 project · top 1 of 1 class shown

nk	Code	ISIC Division Name (Full)	Count	%
1	R-86	Human health activities	1	100.0%

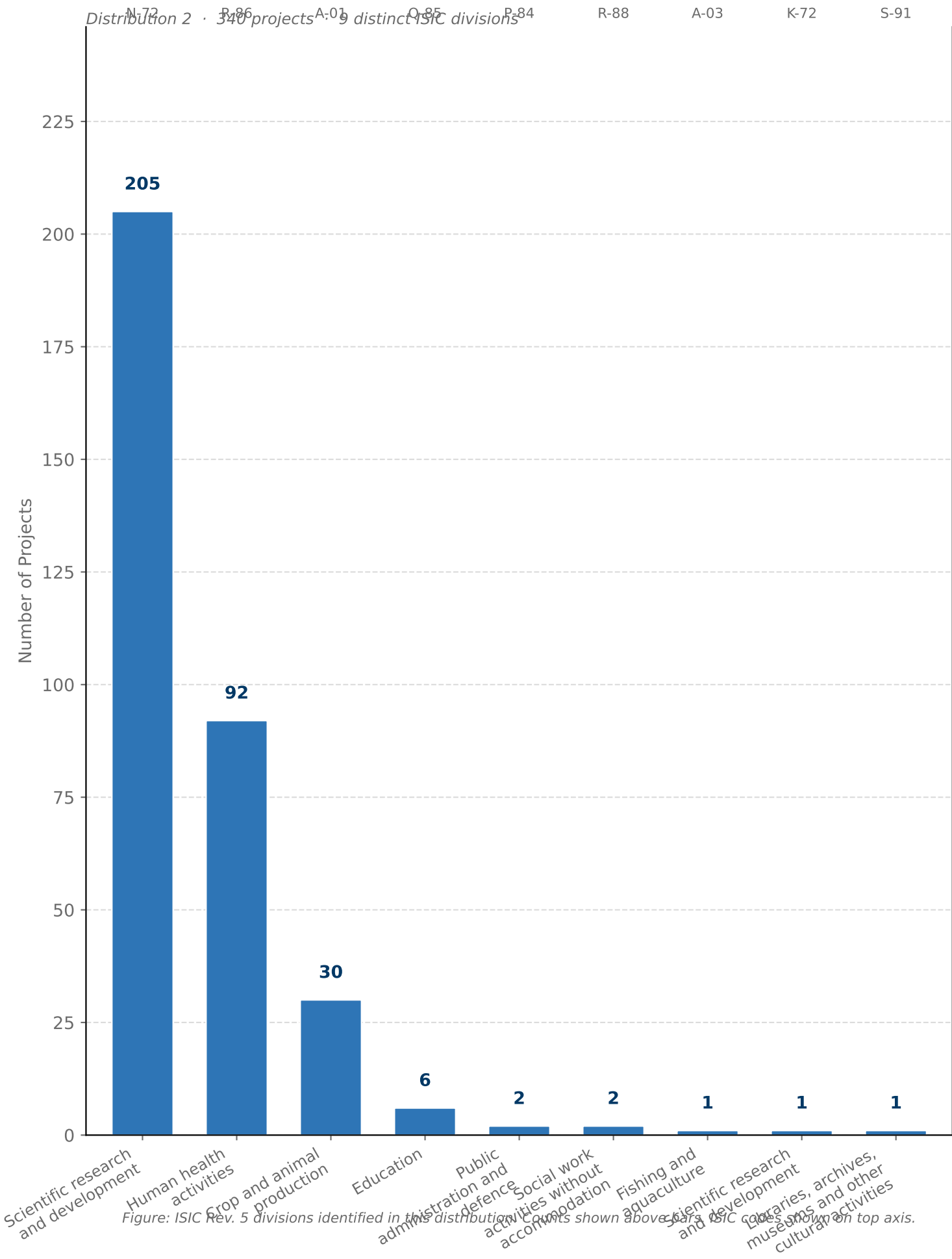
FINDINGS AND DISCUSSION

Only one QDA project was identified across the entire Dryad corpus — a NVivo project file (.nvp) classified as R-86 (Human Health Activities). This assignment suggests the underlying qualitative study concerned medical or patient-related research, which is consistent with the large body of health-science interview studies observed in the broader Dryad QD dataset.

The near-total absence of QDA files in Dryad reflects a structural gap in open-data culture among qualitative researchers. Despite 15 targeted search queries including specific QDA file extension terms ('qdp', 'nvp'), researchers appear to deposit interview transcripts, coded spreadsheets, and final datasets — but not the NVivo or MAXQDA project files that capture the analytical process itself. This is the precise gap that QDArchive is designed to address.

2. Repository 1: Dryad

Dryad — QD Projects: ISIC Division Distribution



2. Repository 1: Dryad

Dryad — QD Projects: Ranked Class Table and Findings

Distribution 2 · 340 projects · top 9 of 9 classes shown

nk	Code	ISIC Division Name (Full)	Count	%
1	N-72	Scientific research and development	205	60.3%
2	R-86	Human health activities	92	27.1%
3	A-01	Crop and animal production	30	8.8%
4	Q-85	Education	6	1.8%
5	P-84	Public administration and defence	2	0.6%
6	R-88	Social work activities without accommodation	2	0.6%
7	A-03	Fishing and aquaculture	1	0.3%
8	K-72	Scientific research and development	1	0.3%
9	S-91	Libraries, archives, museums and other cultural activities	1	0.3%

FINDINGS AND DISCUSSION

Dryad's 340 QD projects span nine ISIC divisions, with three divisions accounting for 96.8% of the distribution. N-72 (Scientific Research and Development) dominates at 60.3% (205 projects), followed by R-86 (Human Health Activities) at 27.1% (92 projects) and A-01 (Crop and Animal Production) at 8.8% (30 projects).

The dominance of N-72 is partly structural: it serves as both the correct classification for general academic research and the classifier's default for ambiguous descriptions. The R-86 cluster is substantively significant — it corresponds to the large body of medical and nursing interview studies identified via queries such as 'semi-structured interview' and 'thematic analysis', which typically deposit anonymised transcripts (.docx, .txt) and coding sheets (.xlsx).

The A-01 presence (8.8%) reflects Dryad's strong life-sciences base. Agricultural researchers use 'qualitative' in a scientific rather than social-science sense (e.g., qualitative assessment of crop traits). These projects — typically containing .csv, .xlsx, and image files — represent noise from broad keyword matching. They are correctly classified as QD_PROJECT rather than QDA_PROJECT since they contain no qualitative data analysis files.

*3. Repository 2: FSD Finland***FSD Finland — QDA Projects: Distribution 3***Distribution 3 · 0 projects · 0 distinct ISIC divisions**No QDA projects were identified in this repository for this distribution.***FINDINGS AND DISCUSSION**

No QDA projects were identified in the FSD Finland corpus. This is a direct consequence of FSD's access control model: all primary data files — interview transcripts, written responses, and coding files — require institutional authentication via the Aila Data Service. Without downloadable files, no project can be assigned the QDA_PROJECT type.

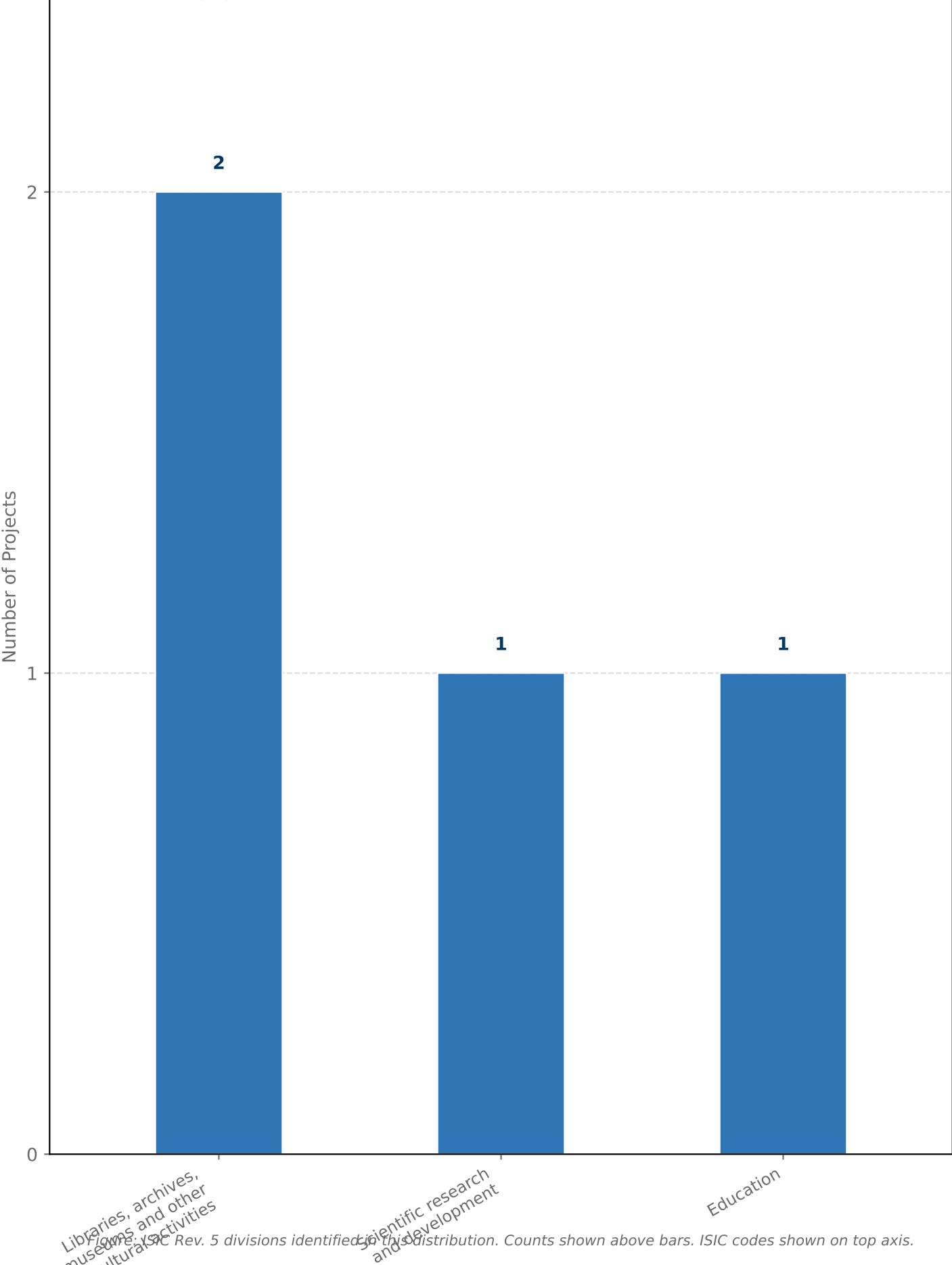
FSD's public catalogue lists 403 English-language qualitative studies, but the only file consistently available without authentication is the DDI-C 2.5 XML metadata record. Some of these studies very likely include QDA analysis files accessible to authenticated users, but this cannot be determined from public data alone. The absence of FSD QDA projects should therefore be interpreted as an access limitation, not as evidence that Finnish social science researchers do not produce QDA files.

3. Repository 2: FSD Finland

FSD Finland — QD Projects: ISIC Division Distribution

Distribution 4 · 4 projects · 3 distinct ISIC divisions

Q-85



ISIC Rev. 5 divisions identified in this distribution. Counts shown above bars. ISIC codes shown on top axis.

3. Repository 2: FSD Finland

FSD Finland — QD Projects: Ranked Class Table and Findings

Distribution 4 · 4 projects · top 3 of 3 classes shown

nk	Code	ISIC Division Name (Full)	Count	%
1	S-91	Libraries, archives, museums and other cultural activities	2	50.0%
2	N-72	Scientific research and development	1	25.0%
3	Q-85	Education	1	25.0%

FINDINGS AND DISCUSSION

Only four FSD studies qualified as QD_PROJECT — those with publicly accessible PDF attachments (typically methodological reports or codebooks) not requiring Aila login. These four projects span three divisions: S-91 (Libraries, Archives and Cultural Activities, 50%), N-72 (Scientific Research, 25%), and Q-85 (Education, 25%).

The disciplinary profile — cultural heritage, research methodology, and education — is consistent with FSD's institutional mandate as Finland's national social science data archive, whose holdings are concentrated in sociology, political science, history, and education research.

The extremely small sample size (n=4) means this distribution cannot be considered representative of FSD's full 403-study catalogue. A meaningful ISIC classification of FSD data would require authenticated Aila access to retrieve the actual primary data files from at least a representative sample of the archived studies.

4. COMPARATIVE ANALYSIS AND CONCLUSION

4.1 CROSS-REPOSITORY OBSERVATIONS

The two repositories exhibit markedly different profiles in terms of both scale and disciplinary coverage. Dryad contributed 340 QD projects across nine ISIC divisions, while FSD Finland contributed only 4 publicly accessible QD projects across three divisions. This disparity does not reflect FSD's actual holdings — FSD catalogues 403 qualitative studies in its English-language archive — but is a direct consequence of the archive's requirement for institutional authentication via the Aila Data Service. Only studies with publicly accessible PDF attachments qualified as QD_PROJECT.

Both repositories are dominated by N-72 (Scientific Research and Development), the expected outcome for academic research collections. The second-ranked division differs sharply: Dryad ranks R-86 (Human Health Activities) second at 27.1%, reflecting its strong life-sciences and clinical research base. FSD's small QD sample shows no R-86 representation; instead S-91 (Libraries, Archives and Cultural Activities) and Q-85 (Education) appear, consistent with Finland's social-science and cultural heritage research tradition.

4.2 QDA FILE AVAILABILITY

Across both repositories, only 1 QDA analysis file was identified — a single NVivo (.nvp) project deposited on Dryad and classified as R-86 (Human Health Activities). This confirms the core challenge motivating QDArchive: researchers who conduct qualitative data analysis with NVivo, MAXQDA, or QDAcity rarely deposit the resulting analysis files in open repositories. Interview transcripts and coded datasets are deposited, but the structured analysis files that capture the analytical process itself remain largely inaccessible. QDArchive therefore cannot be seeded purely by harvesting existing repositories — it must rely on targeted outreach and deposit incentives to build a meaningful QDA file collection.

4.3 CLASSIFICATION CONFIDENCE AND LIMITATIONS

The AI-assisted ISIC classification produces reliable results for projects with descriptive titles, rich abstracts, and multiple keywords. Quality is lower for FSD projects, where only the DDI-C 2.5 XML title and abstract were available — no file content could be read. The large N-72 share also partly reflects the classifier's fallback behaviour: projects with generic or absent descriptions are assigned N-72 rather than a more specific division. A manual review of a sample of N-72 assignments would be required to quantify this effect.

4.4 CONCLUSION

This classification provides a structured, ISIC-aligned view of 1,256 qualitative research projects from Dryad and FSD Finland. The data confirms that qualitative research in the social, health, and agricultural sciences is represented in open repositories — but that QDA analysis files, QDArchive's primary target, are almost entirely absent from open deposit. The classification infrastructure built here — the ISIC classifier, file-level annotation pipeline, and structured SQLite schema — provides a reusable foundation for classifying future acquisitions as QDArchive grows.